

**CODE OF PRACTICE
FOR THE DEVELOPMENT OF
SAFETY DIRECTION:**

**VISION, MISSION, POLICY,
COMMITMENTS, OBJECTIVES
AND TARGETS**

CODE OF PRACTICE FOR THE DEVELOPMENT OF SAFETY DIRECTION: VISION, MISSION, POLICY, COMMITMENTS, OBJECTIVES AND TARGETS

1. Purpose

This Code of Practice establishes the governance, responsibilities and minimum requirements for developing, approving, communicating, implementing and reviewing the organisation's:

- Safety Vision;
- Safety Mission;
- Safety Policy;
- Leadership Commitment Statement;
- Safety Objectives; and
- Safety Targets.

It ensures that safety direction is leadership-led, informed by organisational risks and obligations, developed through consultation, and integrated into corporate and operational planning.

2. Scope

This Code applies to:

- the Board or governing authority;
- the Chief Executive and Executive Leadership Team;
- business and functional leaders;
- the Safety Office;
- managers and supervisors;
- safety committees;
- employees and worker representatives; and
- other relevant internal or external stakeholders.

It applies when the organisation:

- establishes its safety direction for the first time;
- conducts a strategic or organisational review;

- introduces a new safety framework or management system;
- undergoes significant operational, legislative or structural change; or
- reviews existing safety statements, objectives or targets.

3. Principles

The development of safety direction shall be guided by the following principles.

3.1 Leadership Ownership

The Board, Chief Executive and Executive Leadership Team shall own the organisation's safety direction and remain accountable for its relevance, implementation and effectiveness.

The Safety Office may facilitate and draft the documents but shall not determine the organisation's safety direction independently.

3.2 Organisational Alignment

Safety direction shall align with the organisation's:

- mandate and purpose;
- corporate vision, mission and values;
- strategic priorities;
- risk profile;
- legal and regulatory obligations;
- stakeholder expectations; and
- available resources and capabilities.

3.3 Consultation and Participation

Relevant employees, managers, worker representatives and operational stakeholders shall be consulted before the documents are approved.

Consultation shall be proportionate to the organisation's size, structure, risk profile and operating context.

3.4 Evidence-Based Development

Safety objectives and targets shall be based on relevant information, including:

- risk assessments;
- incident and near-miss data;
- audit and inspection findings;

- legal and regulatory requirements;
- performance trends;
- organisational priorities;
- stakeholder feedback; and
- available resources.

3.5 Clarity and Practicality

Safety statements shall be concise, understandable and capable of being translated into operational action.

They shall not consist solely of broad aspirations that cannot be implemented or measured.

3.6 Continual Improvement

Safety direction shall support continual improvement in the organisation's safety performance, systems, behaviours and capabilities.

4. Definitions

Term	Definition
Safety Vision	The organisation's intended long-term safety outcome or desired future state.
Safety Mission	A statement describing how the organisation will work towards its Safety Vision.
Safety Policy	A formal statement of the organisation's safety principles, direction and governance expectations.
Commitment Statement	A statement of specific leadership undertakings that support the Safety Policy.
Safety Objective	A defined safety outcome that the organisation intends to achieve.
Safety Target	A specific and measurable level of performance to be achieved within a defined period.
Safety Office	The function appointed to coordinate, facilitate and provide technical advice on safety management.
Executive Leadership Team	The Chief Executive and senior leaders accountable for organisational strategy and performance.

5. Governance

5.1 Board or Governing Authority

The Board or governing authority shall, where applicable:

- provide oversight of the organisation's safety direction;
- confirm that safety is aligned with organisational governance and strategy;
- review significant safety risks and commitments;
- endorse the Safety Vision and major leadership commitments; and
- monitor organisational safety performance.

5.2 Chief Executive

The Chief Executive shall:

- be accountable for the organisation's Safety Vision, Mission and Policy;
- establish the leadership expectations for safety;
- ensure that appropriate persons are involved in their development;
- approve the final documents;
- ensure that sufficient authority and resources are provided; and
- hold senior leaders accountable for implementation.

5.3 Executive Leadership Team

The Executive Leadership Team shall:

- define the organisation's safety direction;
- consider organisational risks and stakeholder expectations;
- agree on leadership commitments;
- establish strategic safety objectives;
- allocate ownership and resources;
- review proposed targets; and
- monitor implementation and performance.

5.4 Safety Office

The Safety Office shall:

- coordinate the development process;
- prepare relevant organisational and safety information;
- facilitate leadership discussions and consultation;
- draft the documents based on leadership decisions;

- provide technical and regulatory advice;
- coordinate review and approval;
- maintain controlled copies and records; and
- monitor implementation and review requirements.

The Safety Office shall not approve its own drafts unless formally authorised by the Chief Executive.

5.5 Business and Functional Leaders

Business and functional leaders shall:

- identify operational risks, priorities and constraints;
- contribute to the development of objectives and targets;
- confirm that proposed commitments are operationally achievable;
- assign responsibilities within their areas;
- integrate approved requirements into business plans; and
- report progress and performance.

5.6 Managers and Supervisors

Managers and supervisors shall:

- contribute operational perspectives;
- consult employees under their supervision;
- communicate approved requirements;
- translate organisational objectives into local actions;
- monitor implementation; and
- escalate implementation gaps.

5.7 Employees and Worker Representatives

Employees and worker representatives shall be given reasonable opportunities to:

- provide feedback on safety risks and priorities;
- comment on proposed commitments and objectives;
- identify implementation concerns; and
- contribute practical improvement proposals.

6. Required Development Process

6.1 Initiation

The Chief Executive or designated Executive Sponsor shall authorise the commencement of the development or review process.

The initiation shall define:

- the documents to be developed or reviewed;
- the Executive Sponsor;
- the lead coordinating function;
- participating stakeholders;
- intended approval authority; and
- expected completion date.

6.2 Review of Organisational Context

Before drafting begins, the Safety Office shall prepare a summary of the organisation's context.

The review shall consider, where relevant:

- organisational mandate and strategy;
- corporate vision, mission and values;
- operating model and activities;
- internal and external stakeholders;
- legal and regulatory obligations;
- significant safety risks;
- incident and performance history;
- organisational culture and capability;
- internal and external changes;
- resources and constraints; and
- relevant industry or professional practices.

The context review shall be presented to the Executive Leadership Team before decisions are made on the safety direction.

6.3 Leadership Safety Planning Session

A leadership planning session shall be conducted to establish the intended safety direction.

The session should include the Chief Executive, Executive Sponsor, senior business leaders, functional leaders and the Safety Office.

The session shall address:

- the desired future state of safety;
- the organisation's safety purpose;
- safety values and principles;
- leadership expectations;
- unacceptable risks and behaviours;
- strategic priorities;
- organisational commitments;
- proposed objectives;
- resource implications; and
- measures of success.

The Safety Office shall record the decisions, assumptions and actions arising from the session.

6.4 Drafting

The Safety Office shall prepare draft documents based on the decisions made by the leadership team.

Drafting shall distinguish between strategic direction and operational requirements.

Detailed procedures, work instructions and technical controls shall not be placed in the Safety Vision, Mission or Policy unless necessary to establish a clear organisational requirement.

6.5 Consultation

Draft documents shall be circulated to relevant stakeholders for consultation.

Consultation may include:

- senior management review;
- business unit review;
- safety committee review;
- employee engagement sessions;
- worker representative consultation;
- legal or compliance review;
- human resources review;

- communications review; and
- specialist technical review.

Consultation comments shall be documented, considered and resolved before approval.

The Safety Office shall maintain a consultation record showing:

- persons or groups consulted;
- date of consultation;
- feedback received;
- decision taken; and
- rationale for significant amendments or non-acceptance.

6.6 Final Review

Before approval, the Executive Leadership Team shall confirm that the proposed documents:

- align with organisational strategy;
- reflect the organisation's risk profile;
- comply with applicable obligations;
- are supported by adequate resources;
- are clear and achievable;
- assign appropriate accountability;
- can be implemented across the organisation; and
- include suitable monitoring arrangements.

6.7 Approval

The approval authority shall be determined by the organisation's governance arrangements.

As a minimum:

Document	Minimum Approval Authority
Safety Vision	Chief Executive or Board
Safety Mission	Chief Executive
Safety Policy	Chief Executive
Leadership Commitment Statement	Chief Executive and Executive Leadership Team
Safety Objectives	Chief Executive or Executive Leadership Team
Safety Targets	Relevant Executive Leader, with Chief Executive oversight

Approved documents shall include:

- title;
- version number;
- approval date;
- effective date;
- approving authority;
- document owner; and
- review date.

7. Requirements for Each Document

7.1 Safety Vision

The Safety Vision shall:

- describe the organisation's desired long-term safety outcome;
- be concise and future-focused;
- align with the corporate vision and strategy;
- be relevant to the organisation's activities and stakeholders; and
- provide a stable direction for safety improvement.

The Safety Vision should not contain detailed actions, performance measures or procedural requirements.

7.2 Safety Mission

The Safety Mission shall:

- describe the organisation's role in achieving the Safety Vision;
- explain how safety will be integrated into organisational activities;
- reflect leadership, participation, risk management and continual improvement; and
- be capable of guiding strategic and operational decisions.

7.3 Safety Policy

The Safety Policy shall, as applicable, include commitments to:

- provide safe activities, workplaces and environments;
- manage safety risks systematically;
- comply with applicable legal and other requirements;

- prevent injury, ill health and adverse safety outcomes;
- consult and involve employees and relevant stakeholders;
- provide competent persons, training and resources;
- report, investigate and learn from incidents;
- integrate safety into planning and decision-making;
- monitor performance; and
- continually improve the safety management system.

The Safety Policy shall:

- be appropriate to the organisation's purpose and risk profile;
- provide a basis for setting objectives;
- be communicated and made accessible;
- be reviewed periodically; and
- be supported by implementation arrangements.

7.4 Leadership Commitment Statement

The Leadership Commitment Statement shall specify what leaders undertake to do.

Commitments should address:

- visible safety leadership;
- accountability;
- resource provision;
- risk-based decision-making;
- consultation and participation;
- competent staffing;
- transparent reporting;
- learning and improvement;
- integration into business processes; and
- review of safety performance.

Commitments shall be capable of being demonstrated through leadership actions and decisions.

7.5 Safety Objectives

Safety Objectives shall:

- support the Safety Policy;
- respond to significant risks and organisational priorities;

- be relevant to business functions;
- be assigned to accountable owners;
- include implementation plans;
- be monitored; and
- be reviewed periodically.

Objectives may be strategic, functional or operational.

7.6 Safety Targets

Safety Targets shall, where practicable, be:

- specific;
- measurable;
- achievable;
- relevant; and
- time-bound.

Each target shall identify:

- performance measure;
- baseline, where available;
- intended result;
- target date;
- responsible owner;
- reporting frequency; and
- data source.

Targets shall include a balanced mix of leading and lagging indicators.

Targets shall not encourage under-reporting, inappropriate risk-taking or manipulation of safety data.

8. Hierarchy and Relationship of Documents

The safety direction documents shall be developed and applied in the following hierarchy:

1. Corporate mandate, vision and strategy;
2. Safety Vision;
3. Safety Mission;

4. Safety Policy;
5. Leadership Commitment Statement;
6. Safety Objectives;
7. Safety Targets;
8. Programmes, plans and initiatives;
9. Procedures and operational controls; and
10. Performance monitoring and review.

Lower-level documents shall support and remain consistent with higher-level direction.

9. Communication

Approved documents shall be communicated to relevant persons through suitable channels.

Communication may include:

- leadership briefings;
- management meetings;
- employee induction;
- staff training;
- internal communications;
- workplace displays;
- digital platforms;
- contractor briefings; and
- stakeholder engagement.

The organisation shall ensure that personnel understand:

- the Safety Vision and Mission;
- the commitments in the Safety Policy;
- their responsibilities;
- relevant objectives and targets; and
- how their work contributes to the organisation's safety direction.

Communication shall not be limited to publishing the documents.

10. Implementation

Executive leaders and business unit heads shall integrate approved safety direction into:

- strategic plans;
- annual business plans;
- budgets;
- workforce planning;
- procurement;
- project governance;
- programme and event planning;
- performance management;
- competency development;
- risk management;
- contractor management; and
- operational assurance.

Each safety objective shall be supported by an action plan specifying:

- required actions;
- accountable owner;
- supporting parties;
- required resources;
- completion date;
- performance measure; and
- reporting arrangement.

11. Monitoring and Reporting

The Safety Office shall coordinate monitoring of the organisation's safety objectives, targets and commitments.

Performance reports shall include, where relevant:

- progress against objectives and targets;
- significant safety risks;
- incidents and trends;
- audit and inspection findings;
- implementation gaps;
- resource constraints;

- corrective actions;
- emerging issues; and
- recommended leadership decisions.

Performance shall be reviewed by the Executive Leadership Team at planned intervals.

Significant failures, delays or emerging risks shall be escalated promptly and shall not be deferred until the next scheduled review.

12. Review

The Safety Vision, Mission, Policy, Commitment Statement, Objectives and Targets shall be reviewed:

- at planned intervals;
- following significant organisational change;
- following a serious incident;
- following material legislative or regulatory change;
- where performance indicates that the direction is no longer effective;
- where strategic priorities change; or
- when directed by the Board or Chief Executive.

The Safety Policy should be formally reviewed at least once every three years, unless the organisation specifies a shorter period.

Safety Objectives and Targets shall be reviewed at least annually.

A review need not result in amendment where the documents remain relevant and effective. The decision to retain the existing version shall be recorded.

13. Document Control and Records

The Safety Office shall maintain controlled records of:

- organisational context review;
- leadership workshop materials;
- draft versions;
- consultation feedback;
- legal and technical reviews;
- approval records;

- communication activities;
- objectives and action plans;
- performance reports;
- review decisions; and
- superseded versions.

Only current approved versions shall be issued for organisational use.

Superseded documents shall be withdrawn from active use and retained in accordance with the organisation's record retention requirements.

14. Assurance

The organisation shall periodically verify whether:

- the development process was followed;
- leadership participated meaningfully;
- consultation was conducted;
- approved documents remain aligned with organisational strategy;
- objectives and targets are being implemented;
- commitments are reflected in leadership behaviour and decisions;
- performance information is reliable; and
- corrective actions are completed.

Assurance may be conducted through:

- internal audit;
- governance review;
- management review;
- safety committee review;
- independent assessment; or
- other approved assurance processes.

15. Non-Conformance

The following shall be treated as non-conformance with this Code:

- safety direction developed without leadership involvement;
- documents issued without authorised approval;

- objectives or targets established without accountable owners;
- commitments made without implementation arrangements or resources;
- targets that encourage non-reporting or concealment;
- failure to consult relevant stakeholders;
- failure to review outdated documents;
- use of superseded versions; or
- material inconsistency between safety documents and organisational practices.

Non-conformances shall be recorded, assigned to an accountable owner and addressed within an appropriate timeframe.

Annex A — Responsibility Matrix

Activity	Board	Chief Executive	Executive Leadership	Safety Office	Business Leaders	Employees / Reps
Approve development process	I	A	C	R	I	I
Review organisational context	I	A	C	R	C	C
Define Safety Vision	C/A	A/R	C	C	C	I
Define Safety Mission	I	A	R	C	C	I
Draft Safety Policy	I	A	C	R	C	C
Define leadership commitments	C	A	R	C	C	I
Establish Safety Objectives	I	A	R	C	C	I
Develop Safety Targets	I	A	C	C	R	I
Conduct consultation	I	I	C	R	C	C
Approve final documents	C/A	A	C	I	I	I
Implement requirements	I	A	R	C	R	R
Monitor performance	I	A	C	R	R	C
Review effectiveness	C	A	R	C	C	C

Legend

- **R** — Responsible
- **A** — Accountable
- **C** — Consulted
- **I** — Informed

Annex B — Minimum Development Records

No.	Record	Record Owner
1	Development authorisation	Executive Sponsor
2	Organisational context assessment	Safety Office
3	Leadership workshop attendance and decisions	Safety Office
4	Draft documents	Safety Office
5	Consultation record	Safety Office
6	Legal and compliance review	Legal / Compliance
7	Approval record	Chief Executive's Office
8	Communication plan and evidence	Communications / Safety Office
9	Objectives, targets and action plans	Relevant Business Owner
10	Performance and management review records	Safety Office
11	Review and revision records	Document Owner

Annex C — Recommended Development Sequence

Stage	Key Activity	Intended Output
1	Confirm development mandate and sponsor	Approved scope and governance
2	Assess organisational context	Context and risk summary
3	Conduct leadership planning workshop	Agreed safety direction
4	Draft Vision, Mission, Policy and Commitments	Draft strategic documents
5	Develop Objectives and Targets	Draft performance framework
6	Consult stakeholders	Consultation record and revised drafts
7	Conduct final leadership review	Final documents
8	Obtain formal approval	Approved controlled documents
9	Communicate and integrate	Implementation plans
10	Monitor and review	Performance and review records